

July 09, 2026

Rositch Hemphill Architects
#10 - 120 Powell Street
Vancouver, BC
V6A 1G1

**RE: 80 Powell Street Vancouver, BC
Development permit application number DP-2025-00672**

Your application was considered by the Development Permit Board at its meeting of June 22, 2026, THAT the Board APPROVE Development Application No. DP-2025-00672, submitted, the plans and information forming a part thereof, thereby permitting the development a 13-storey mixed-use commercial building, consisting of Hotel use on the ground to 12th floor, and retail use at grade and Restaurant use on the 13th floor, over one level of underground parking and having vehicular access from the lane, subject to the following conditions:

1.0 Prior to issuance of the development permit, revised drawings and information shall be submitted to the satisfaction of the Director of Planning, clearly indicating:

1.1 design development to enhance the overall public realm, further strengthen the pedestrian activity and reinforce legibility of the former CPR right-of-way by the following:

i. at the proposed Privately Owned Public Space (POPS):

a. improve the expression of the prominent column and the soffit;

Note to Applicant: Given the high visibility from the public realm, the expression and the treatment of the round column and the soffit should be high-quality and contribute to a cohesive and legible pedestrian realm as a significant former CPR right-of-way. Refer also to Recommended condition 1.1 i.d. for visually appealing architecturally integral light fixtures at the covered plaza.

b. relocate the main entrance of the retail/service from the east toward the north with exploration of high-quality operable glazing system that allow for improved direct visual and physical connection between the retail uses and the adjacent covered plaza fronting on Powell Street;

- c. improve design for human scale that contributes to the historic streetscape;

Note to Applicant: Suggested strategies include introducing fine-grained architectural detailing, high-quality material treatment, textured finishes and articulation. Large blank wall conditions should be avoided as much as possible, particularly at the exit stairs and elevator cores that interfaces with the public realm along north, south and west.

- d. provision of comprehensive wayfinding strategies with legible building entrances and enhanced lighting strategies to provide for visually appealing and active illumination of the public realm to ensure high level of perceived safety and pedestrian comfort at all hours;

Note the Applicant: An architectural, landscape lighting and wayfinding strategies should demonstrate the design approach and distinguishing the commercial and hotel entries. Consideration should be given to adding a visually appealing architecturally integral light fixtures at the covered plaza. Proposed light fixtures should be provided on the architectural and landscape drawings, and may require supplemental reflected ceiling plans, perspective images, or other architectural drawings. Refer also to Urban Design Panel #2 consensus recommendations, dated April 22, 2026.

Note to Applicant: Refer also Standard Urban Design conditions A.1.1, A.1.2, A.1.5, A.1.16 and Standard Landscape condition A.1.17.

- ii. at the rear lane:

- a. delete Class A Loading, and replace with 1.5 m (5 ft.) pullout space to accommodate goods loading and passenger loading vehicles;

Note to Applicant: Paving treatments at the pullout space, including materiality, patterning, and colour, should be contrasting to clearly delineate between POPS and loading pullout area with architecturally integral bollards to address pedestrian safety concerns while strengthening the pedestrian connection through the site. Refer also to Standard Engineering Services condition A.2.10.

- b. demonstrate design strategies with exploration of improved landscape and surface treatments particularly at the hotel entrance to soften this interface and create a more welcoming experience for the hotel guests and pedestrians;

1.2 design development to improve the building expression by the following:

- i. refine the varied fenestration and provide a more legible and consistent pattern around the building elevations with high-quality detailing;

Note to Applicant: As shown, the fenestration patterns do not appear fully compatible with the heritage context. Refer also to Standard Urban Design condition A.1.3 and Urban Design Panel #2 consensus recommendations, dated April 22, 2026.

- ii. simplify the building massing, particularly along elevations that are highly visible from the public realm.

Note to Applicant: This can be achieved by extending the floor plate without a setback along west and east elevations at the north and south corners and mitigating blank wall conditions by providing window openings with consistent fenestration patterns and façade treatments.

Note to Applicant: The intent is to strengthen the unique geometry of the diagonal cut shaped site on this important former CPR railway while ensuring compatibility with the heritage context.

2.0 That the conditions set out in Appendix A be met prior to the issuance of the Development Permit.

3.0 That the Notes to Applicant and Conditions of the Development Permit set out in Appendix B be approved by the Board.

IMPORTANT - PRIOR TO RESPONSE SUBMISSION

Upload a complete Prior-to-Response electronically through the Applicant's online external user account (login at "<https://plposweb.vancouver.ca/Public/Login.aspx>")

- Ensure items by registered professionals are digitally signed and sealed (if/as applicable). Refer to <https://vancouver.ca/home-property-development/electronic-permit-applications.aspx>
- Provide a signed written response describing how you have addressed each of the Prior to Letter conditions including a detailed list of any changes deviating from the original submission.
- Partial submissions will not be accepted.
- Repeated incomplete resubmissions may be subject to additional review, fees and longer processing times.

Contact your project facilitator Christine.Fong@vancouver.ca with any questions or concerns.

This letter is based on the minutes of the Development Permit Board meeting of June 22, 2026, which have not yet been adopted by the Board. If any amendments to this approval are made by the Board at its next meeting, you will be advised immediately.

Yours truly,



Maitrayee Shah, Project Coordinator
Development Review Branch
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Phone: 604-707-5407

MS/jk

cc: Christine Fong- Project Facilitator

Property Owner:

80 Powell Street Holdings Ltd
504 – 189 Columbia St
Vancouver, BC
V6A 2R4

APPENDIX A

DEVELOPMENT PERMIT STAFF COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS

The following is a list of conditions that must also be met prior to issuance of the Development Permit.

A.1 Standard Conditions

Urban Design Conditions

- A.1.1 arrangements are to be made to the satisfaction of the Director of Planning and the Director of Legal Services for a Statutory Right of Way (SRW) for public life use over the proposed Privately Owned Public Space (POPs);

Note to Applicant: Refer also to Recommended Condition 1.1.

- A.1.2 provision of updated site plan and landscape plans as follows:

- i. include the proposed POPS signage location(s);
- ii. clearly note the following notations:

“Contractor to contact City of Vancouver Sign Shop at nysignshop@vancouver.ca to coordinate an order for standard POPS sign. Include billing address, contact name and phone number, number of POPS signs required and planned pickup date at National Yard for the signs. Once this information is received, a unique job number will be created for the Contractor. Accounts Receivable Clerk will then process the invoice and bill out the final amount accordingly.”;

Note to Applicant: Standardized Privately Owned Public Space (POPS) signage should be installed in a highly visible location(s) within the POPS SRW area, at the applicant's expense.

- A.1.3 provision of a typical enlarged architectural details with dimensions indicating the following:

- i. soffit at the covered plaza;
- ii. façade of the Terra Cotta panels with vertical textured finish and red metal accents;
- iii. interface of the prominent column and the ground level public realm;

Note to Applicant: The detailing of these building elements should contribute to the long term performance of the building as an importance place in the city. Architectural design details, rather than building envelope or construction details, are required for development permit review. Details should generally be in section, at a large scale such as 1:20 or equivalent, and include notes and dimensions. Review of these drawings may result in additional Urban Design comments or conditions. Refer also to Recommended Condition 1.2.

- A.1.4 design development to consider the servicing requirements of the hotel operations;

Note to Applicant: Drawings should demonstrate detailed resolution of building services, including waste, back-of-house and electrical/mechanical spaces, and locate these functions away from the ground floor as much as possible to ensure performance of the POPS is not compromised. Refer also to Urban Design Panel #2 consensus recommendations, dated April 22, 2026 and Engineering Condition A. 2.9.

- A.1.5 consideration to meaningfully integrate the site history into the proposal as an important former CPR right-of-way;

Note to Applicant: This may be achieved through the incorporation of culturally appropriate public art, storytelling elements, site furnishings, materials and landscape treatments that reference the historic rail corridor. Refer also to *Gastown Public Spaces Plan* and Urban Design Panel #2 consensus recommendations, dated April 22, 2026.

- A.1.6 demonstration to the satisfaction of the Director of Planning that noise from adjacent rail operations have been appropriately addressed by providing the following:

- i. provision of a letter of assurance from a Qualified Professional confirming that interior and exterior noise standards as outlined in the Appendix C of the [Guidelines for New Development in Proximity to Railway Operations](#) have been met; or
- ii. requirements of section 2.1.3 of the [Developments in Proximity to Rail Facilities Bulletin](#) have been met;

- A.1.7 entry into legal agreements identified in section 2.3.1 [Developments in Proximity to Rail Facilities Bulletin](#) of the satisfaction of the General Manager of Engineering Services, Legal Services and Planning Urban Design & Sustainability;

- A.1.8 provision of written acknowledgment(s) from all relevant rail authorities confirming receipt of the complete application and reports from the applicant;

Note to Applicant: Refer to section 2.4 of the [Developments in Proximity to Rail Facilities Bulletin](#). Written acknowledgment in the form of an email from an authorized representative of the Rail Authority will be accepted in place of written acknowledgment on company letterhead.

Development Review Branch Conditions

- A.1.9 make arrangements (legal agreements) to the satisfaction of the General Manager of Engineering Services & Director of Legal Services for the registration of an indemnity agreement for the portions of the building that encroach on to the site to the West of the application site;

Note to Applicant: Confirmation of registration of an Easement agreement with the adjoining property owner(s) is recommended. Please note that the City is not a party to this agreement between adjacent landowners.

A.1.10 make arrangements to the satisfaction of the General Manager of Engineering Services, Director of Legal Services, and Chief Building Official for a Flood Plain Covenant;

Note to Applicant: The site is located in designated flood plain. Refer also to Flood Plain Guidelines: <https://guidelines.vancouver.ca/guidelines-flood-plain-standards-requirements.pdf>. See also Appendix F for Building Review Branch comments.

A.1.11 provision of geodetic elevations at top of parapet and guardrails on Elevations and Section;

Note to Applicant: Building height would be considered from the lowest interpolated level on the base surface to the top of parapet. Please update the building height information on the Data Summary sheet DWG A0.2 by noting the height to the top of parapet above level 14.

A.1.12 provision of written confirmation from a code consultant that the proposed water feature at grade along the west property line will not compromise the safe egress of occupants from the neighbouring building's emergency exits;

A.1.13 provision of drawings by renaming the proposed 'micro food commercial retail unit' to 'retail unit' on Level 1 Plan;

A.1.14 provision of the following notations to be included on the submitted plans:

- i. "The design of the parking structure regarding safety and security shall be in accordance with Section 4.10 of the Parking By-law";
- ii. "A minimum of one electrical outlet shall be provided for each two Class A bicycle spaces";
- iii. "All building dimensions, setbacks and yards are to the outside of cladding";
- iv. "The design of bicycle spaces (including bicycle rooms, compounds, lockers and/or racks) regarding safety and security measures and end of trip facilities regarding required design standards shall be in accordance with the relevant provisions of Section 6 of the Parking By-law";
- v. "Mechanical equipment (ventilators, generators, compactors, and exhaust systems) will be designed and located to minimize noise impacts on the neighbourhood and comply with Noise By-law No. 6555";
- vi. "The acoustical measures will be incorporated into the final design and construction, based on the consultant's recommendations";

A.1.15 written confirmation that the site sign(s) have been removed;

Crime Prevention Through Environmental Design (CPTED)

A.1.16 design development to incorporate the principles of Crime Prevention Through Environmental Design (CPTED) including:

- i. provide architectural integral parkade gate;

- ii. maximize opportunities for natural surveillance;
- iii. provide unobstructed and transparent sightlines to exits and destinations;
- iv. having particular regard for mischief in alcoves and vandalism such as graffiti;
- v. outdoor common area and path lighting;
- vi. visibility and security in the underground parking garage in accordance with the Parking By-law including:
 - a. providing 24 hour overhead lighting at exit doors and steps lights;
 - b. providing white-painted walls;
 - c. ensuring a high degree of visibility at doors, lobbies, stairs, and other access routes;

Note to Applicant: Light fixture types, locations, and illumination levels should be indicated on the landscape or site plans, and should be integrated into the site and building design. Site lighting should address strategies for path and exit lights, wayfinding, security, decoration, and mail delivery. Exterior lights should be oriented away from adjacent residential properties.

Landscape Conditions

- A.1.17 design development to provide permanent publicly accessible seating integrated into the POPS design, particularly at the covered plaza along Powell Street, to ensure the POPS does not solely rely on movable tables and chairs to function as a public space;

Note to Applicant: Refer also to Urban Design condition 1.1 and Standard Urban Design condition A.1.5.

- A.1.18 design development to incorporate appropriate measures to prevent climbing vegetation from damaging the rear brick facade of the neighboring building;

Note to Applicant: The proposed planting scheme includes suckering species (*Parthenocissus tricuspidata* and *Hydrangea anomala petiolaris*). These shall be replaced with non-suckering species only. Consideration of alternative design solutions to improve the public realm interface along the west property line, as the vines shown in the rendering may not thrive due to limited sunlight availability.

A.2 Standard Engineering Conditions

- A.2.1 provision of Design Elevations to be shown on the Level 1 plan/sheet A3.0;

Note to Applicant: Two Design Elevations at parkade ramp are missing (see markup for location/details).

A.2.2 provision of an updated landscape and site plan to reflect the public realm changes including all of the off-site improvements sought for this development permit. The following items and notes are to be added to the landscape plan:

- i. provision of new street trees adjacent to the development site, where applicable and include a notation on the plan as follows:

"Final spacing and quantity to the satisfaction of the General Manager of Engineering Services. New trees must be of good standard, installed with approved root barriers and appropriate soil. Installation of Engineered Soil may be required to obtain appropriate soil volumes based on site conditions. Root barriers shall be of rigid construction, 8 feet long and 18 inches in depth. Planting depth of root ball must be below sidewalk grade. Contact Park Board at pbdevelopment.trees@vancouver.ca for tree species specification and for inspection after tree planting completion.";

- ii. clearly note the following statement on the Landscape Plan:

"This plan is "NOT FOR CONSTRUCTION" and is to be submitted for review to Engineering Services a minimum of 8 weeks prior to the start of any construction proposed for public property. No work on public property may begin until such plans receive "For Construction" approval and related permits are issued. Please contact Engineering, Development Services and/or your Engineering, Building Site Inspector for details".

- iii. indicate removal of the existing driveway crossing and reconstruction of the boulevard, sidewalk and curb to current standards on Powell Street;
- iv. note on drawings that new or replacement duct banks that meet current City standard are required if sidewalks are replaced;

Note to Applicant: Duct banks are to consist of electrical and communication ducts and cables that connect to existing electrical and communication infrastructure.

Note to Applicant: Where a design or detail is not available, make note of the improvement on the site and landscape plans.

A.2.3 provision of updated Parking By-law statistics table(s) noting the following:

- i. calculations for the minimum required parking, loading, bicycle, end-of-trip facilities and passenger loading spaces, and the number of spaces being provided for same, by each site use;
- ii. clearly note the following statements on the plans:
 - a. *"Parking, loading, bicycle, and passenger loading shall be provided and designed in compliance with the Parking By-law and the Parking and Loading Design Supplement"*;
 - b. *"End of Trip Facilities layout shall be in compliance with the Vancouver Parking By-law and the Vancouver Building By-law"*;

- A.2.4 provision of Parking access, per [Parking By-law Section 4](#) and the [Design Supplement](#), including the following:
- i. convex mirrors or view portals on the main ramp;
 - ii. safe, functional grades on the ramp and in parking areas including:
 - a. maximum 15% ramp grade after the first 6.1 m (20 ft) from the property line;
 - b. maximum 5% crossfall grades for maneuvering aisle for Class A loading spaces;
- A.2.5 provision of vehicle space(s), per [Parking By-law Section 4](#) and the [Design Supplement](#), including a minimum 5.0 m (16.4 ft) width, 5.5 m (18 ft) length and 2.3 m (7.5 ft) vertical clearance for van accessible spaces;
- A.2.6 provision of loading space(s), per [Parking By-law Section 5](#) and the [Design Supplement](#), including a minimum 2.7 m (8.9 ft) width, 5.5 m (18 ft) length for Class A spaces;
- A.2.7 provision of passenger space(s), per [Parking By-law Section 7](#) and the [Design Supplement](#), including:
- i. minimum 4.0 m (13.1 ft) width and 5.5 m (18 ft) length for the first Class A space;
 - ii. minimum 2.9 m (9.5 ft) width and 5.5 m (18 ft) length after the first Class A space;
- A.2.8 provision of general revisions to the architectural plans:
- i. all types of parking, loading, bicycle, end-of-trip facilities and passenger loading spaces individually numbered, and labelled on the drawings;
 - ii. ramp/parkade warning and/or signal systems details, including locations of lights, signs and detection devices;
 - iii. design elevations at all breakpoints on both sides of ramps, drive aisles, loading and passenger loading spaces, accessible spaces, and entrances;
- A.2.9 provision of waste management plan that clarifies garbage/recycling pick up operations and storage locations;

Note to Applicant: For more information please refer to the Garbage and Recycling Facility Storage Amenity Design Supplement: <https://guidelines.vancouver.ca/guidelines-garbage-recycling-storage-facility-design.pdf>

- A.2.10 parking, loading, bicycle, and passenger loading space quantities must be provided and maintained in accordance with the requirements of the [Parking By-Law](#).

Note to Applicant: Due to site specific constraints, a 5 ft setback adjacent the rear lane between the western property line and the parking ramp to allow for a pullout space for goods and passenger loading vehicles will be accepted in lieu of 3 Class B loading and 1

APPENDIX B

Standard Notes to Applicant

- B.1.1 It should be noted that if conditions 1.0 and 2.0 have not been addressed on or before **December 22, 2026**, unless extended by the Director of Planning.
- B.1.2 This approval is subject to any change in the Official Development Plan and the Zoning and Development Bylaw or other regulations affecting the development that occurs before the permit is issuable. No permit that contravenes the bylaw or regulations can be issued.
- B.1.3 Revised drawings will not be accepted unless they fulfill all conditions noted above. Further, written explanation describing point-by-point how conditions have been met, must accompany revised drawings. An appointment should be made with the Project Facilitator when the revised drawings are ready for submission.
- B.1.4 A new development application will be required for any significant changes other than those required by the above-noted conditions.
- B.1.5 Any existing City infrastructure adjacent to the site damaged during construction activities must be replaced to current COV Engineering Design Manual, Construction Specifications, Standard Detail Drawing, Canadian Electrical Code and the Master Municipal Construction Documents. Replacement is to be determined at the sole discretion of the General Manager of Engineering Services.
- B.1.6 The owner or representative is advised to contact Engineering to acquire the project's permissible street use. Prepare a mitigation plan to minimize street use during excavation and construction (i.e. consideration to the building design or sourcing adjacent private property to construct from) and be aware that a minimum 60 days lead time for any major crane erection / removal or slab pour that requires additional street use beyond the already identified project street use permissions.

B.1 Conditions of Development Permit:

- B.2.1 All approved off-street parking, loading, bike, and passenger loading spaces shall be provided in accordance with the relevant requirements of the Parking By-law prior to the issuance of any required occupancy permit, or any use or occupancy of the proposed development not requiring an occupancy permit, and thereafter permanently maintained in good condition.
- B.2.2 All impacted utility companies shall be contacted and notified of the following requirements:
 - i. All utility services (eg. BC Hydro, Telus, and Rogers) shall be underground.
 - ii. All required electrical equipment (e.g. BC Hydro, Telus, and Rogers) shall be underground.

Note to Applicant: The review of third-party utility service drawings (e.g. BC Hydro, Telus, and Rogers) will not be initiated until all drawings have been received by the

Utilities Management Branch (UMB). For questions on this requirement, please contact UMB at umb@vancouver.ca.

- B.2.3 A Key Plan shall be submitted by the applicant, and approved by the City prior to any third party utility drawing submissions. It is highly recommended that the applicant submit a Key Plan to the City for review as part of the Building Permit application. Third party utility service drawings will not be reviewed by the City until the Key Plan is defined and achieves the following objectives:

- i. The Key Plan shall follow the specifications in the City of Vancouver Key Plan Process and Requirements Bulletin <https://vancouver.ca/files/cov/Key%20Plan%20Process%20and%20Requirements.pdf>
- ii. All third party service lines to the development are to be shown on the plan (e.g., BC Hydro, Telus, Shaw, etc.) and the applicant is to provide documented acceptance from the third party utilities prior to submitting to the City.

Note to Applicant: Use of street for temporary power (e.g., temporary pole, pole mounted transformer or ducting) is to be coordinated with the city well in advanced of construction. Requests will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis with justification provided substantiating need of street space against other alternatives. If street use for temporary power is not approved, alternate means of providing power will need to be proposed. An electrical permit will be required.

For questions on this requirement, please contact the Utilities Management Branch at umb@vancouver.ca.

- B.2.4 Construction dewatering is a Water Use Purpose under the Water Sustainability Act requiring a provincial Approval or License.

Note to Applicant: Applications for provincial Approvals or Licenses can be completed online. The application will be received and accepted into the province's online system, and the provincial authorizations team strives for 140 days to get the approval to the applicant. The approval holder must be able to produce their approval on site so that it may be shown to a government official upon request. Dewatering before this approval is granted is not in compliance with the provincial Water Sustainability Act.

- B.2.5 The detailed Electrical Design will be required prior to the start of any associated electrical work to the satisfaction of the General Manager of Engineering Services, and, in conformance with current COV Engineering Design Manual, Construction Specifications, Standard Detail Drawing, Canadian Electrical Code and the Master Municipal Construction Documents.

- B.2.6 The property owner must fulfill requirements of Section 571(B) of the Vancouver Charter and Section 85.1(2) of the Land Title Act by submitting a complete and accurate Site Disclosure Statement and entering into legal agreements, if required, as follows: i) an agreement to remediate the site and contaminants that have migrated therefrom; and ii) a Section 219 Covenant to restrict occupancy until a Certificate of Compliance or Final Determination is issued by Ministry of Environment and Climate Change Strategy for the

site, including any dedicated lands. A qualified environmental consultant must be available to identify, characterize and appropriately manage any environmental media of suspect quality which may be encountered during any subsurface work. All work on the site must be conducted in compliance with British Columbia's Environmental Management Act and Contaminated Sites Regulation. In the event that contamination of any environmental media is encountered, a Contaminated Site Groundwater Quality Declaration or Waste Discharge Permit Application must be submitted prior to commencing dewatering activities. All landscaping and treatment of the open portions of the site shall be completed in accordance with the approved drawings prior to the issuance of any required occupancy permit or any use or occupancy of the proposed development not requiring an occupancy permit and thereafter permanently maintained in good condition.

- B.2.7 Any phasing of the development, other than that specifically approved, that results in an interruption of continuous construction to completion of the development, will require application to amend the development to determine the interim treatment of the incomplete portions of the site to ensure that the phased development functions are as set out in the approved plans, all to the satisfaction of the Director of Planning.

B.2.8 This site is affected by a Development Cost Levy By-law and levies will be required to be paid prior to issuance of Building Permits.

- B.2.9 Provision of construction details to determine ability to meet municipal design standards for shotcrete removal (street restoration manual section 02596 and Encroachment By-law (#4243 section 3A) and access around existing and future utilities adjacent to your site.

Note to Applicant: Detailed confirmations of these commitments will be sought at the building permit stage with final design achievements certified and confirmed with survey and photographic evidence of removals and protection of adjacent utilities prior to building occupancy. Provision of written acknowledgement of this condition is required. Please contact Engineering Services for details.